

Reserved Seating Feature

Company: Vega Events

Overview: Vega's ticketing platform initially supported only general admission events, limiting schools that needed reserved seating for performances, graduations, and other assigned-seat events. I designed a Reserved Seating experience by integrating the Seats.io platform into Vega's existing ticketing workflow while navigating complex technical constraints. By preserving familiar patterns from the general admission experience, the feature enabled schools to adopt reserved seating with minimal learning curve and a seamless transition.

Team: Chief Executive Officer, Chief Product Officer, Software Development, QA Development

My Role: Product Strategy, UX/UI Product Design, UX Researcher

Date: Jan 2026 - Feb 2026

Problem

Vega's ticketing platform was originally built for General Admission events, leaving schools without a native way to manage reserved seating. As schools hosted concerts, theater productions, graduations, and other assigned-seat events, they relied on fragmented workflows or third-party tools to create seating charts, reserve seats, and manage ticket pricing. The challenge was to introduce reserved seating without disrupting the familiar ticketing experience schools already relied on.

Solution

I designed an end-to-end Reserved Seating experience by integrating Seats.io into Vega's existing ticketing workflow. The solution enables schools to create and manage seat maps, assign multiple ticket types and pricing tiers, reserve seats for designated groups, and manage seat availability—all while preserving the familiar workflows administrators already knew.

Process

Research & Discovery

I partnered with stakeholders and interviewed school administrators to better understand how they managed reserved seating events. While every school approached the problem differently, consistent patterns emerged around the flexibility they needed to manage complex seating arrangements.

Key Insights

- Schools needed to create and manage custom seat maps.
- Reserved seating often required multiple pricing tiers and ticket types.

- Administrators needed to reserve or block seats for groups such as staff, media, performers, and families.
- Existing workflows relied on multiple disconnected tools, creating unnecessary complexity.
- These conversations revealed an opportunity to expand Vega's ticketing platform beyond General Admission while keeping the experience approachable for existing customers.

Opportunity

Rather than building a completely separate reserved seating product, I explored how reserved seating could become a natural extension of Vega's existing ticketing workflow.

The primary design challenge wasn't creating seating charts—it was integrating a third-party platform (Seats.io) into an established product without forcing users to learn an entirely new system.

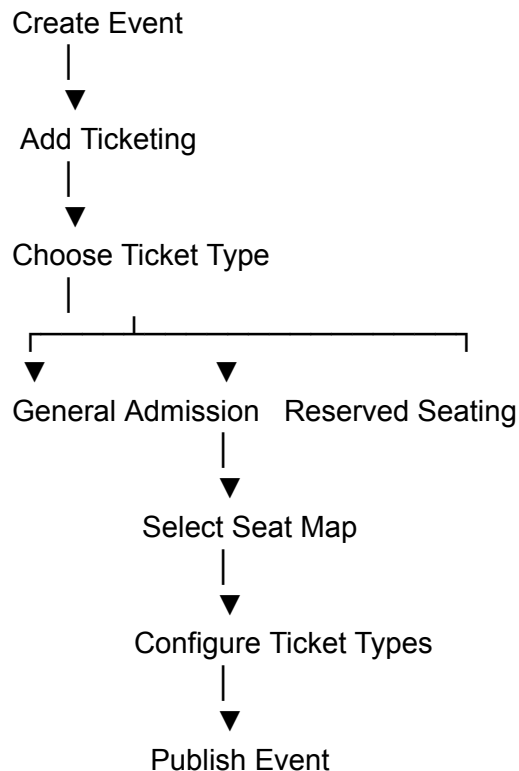
My guiding principle became:

Add new capabilities without introducing a new mental model.

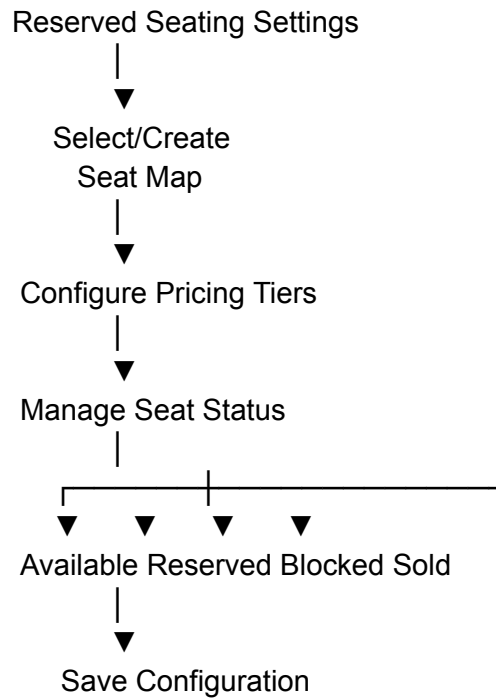
User Flows

Before designing interfaces, I mapped the administrator journey to identify where reserved seating should integrate into the existing event creation flow.

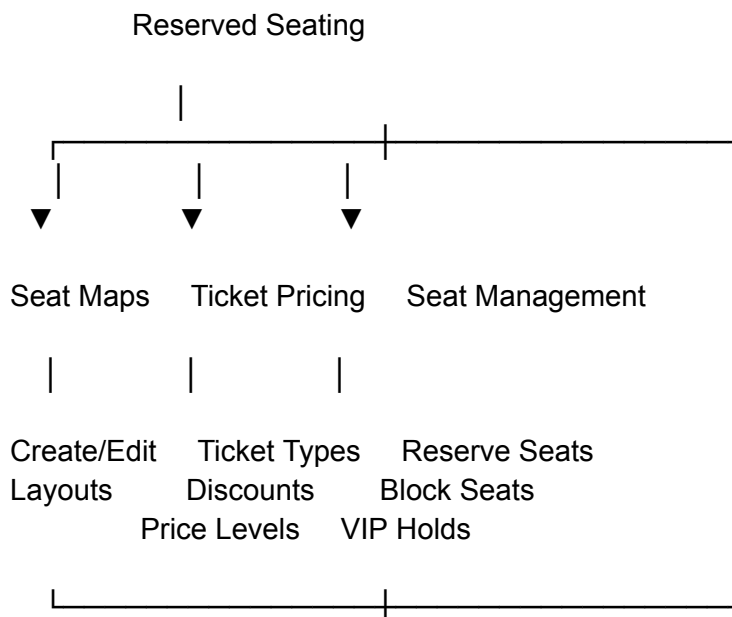
Event Setup Flow



Reserved Seating Management



Ecosystem Diagramming





Published Ticketed Event

Mapping these flows early helped identify where new functionality could fit naturally into existing workflows without increasing cognitive load.

Design & Iteration

Because Seats.io introduced technical constraints around seat map creation and management, I worked closely with Product and Engineering to understand what functionality could be exposed within Vega.

Rather than exposing the complexity of the integration, I designed a lightweight Reserved Seating settings panel that fit seamlessly within Vega's existing ticketing configuration.

Administrators could easily:

- Enable reserved seating
 - Select or create a seat map
 - Configure ticket pricing
 - Manage seat availability
 - Reserve seats for specific groups
 - Throughout the design process, I prioritized consistency with the General Admission experience so users could adopt the new feature with minimal learning curve.
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Outcome

The Reserved Seating feature expanded Vega's ticketing capabilities to support a much broader range of school events while maintaining a familiar administrative experience. By integrating Seats.io into existing workflows, schools gained powerful seating management tools without sacrificing usability.

The project reinforced the importance of designing around technical constraints rather than exposing them to users. Instead of introducing an entirely new workflow, the final solution extended an existing one—allowing administrators to accomplish more while interacting with an interface they already understood.